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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM MGU-UGP (Honours)/MGU-BBA (Honours)/MGU-BCA (Honours) Special Examinations, July 2026 (for 2024 Admission Regular Examinations, October 2025)

THIRD SEMESTER

(DSC) - MG3DSCENG201 – APPRECIATING POETRY

Scheme of Valuation

Part A - MCQ

Answer all questions. Each question carries 1 mark

1	a) Ease	CO1
2	c) The double nature of poetic inspiration—sublime and terrifying	CO2
3	b) Personal	CO3
4	c) World War I	CO4
5	a) What objects inspire it	CO2
6	b) It represents the Tyger's fiery passion and energy	CO1
7	b) Measureless to man	CO2
8	a) He considers it a curse	CO3
9	d) 1955	CO4
10	a) Domineering	CO3

(1 × 10 = 10)

Part B — Short Answer

Answer any 6 questions. Each question carries 5 marks

11. Love compared to a fresh red rose and a sweet melody · Deep, passionate, sincere love · Promise of everlasting love · Hyperbolic images of permanence · Theme of ideal, faithful love. (CO1)

12. Lucy lives unnoticed in isolation · Violet by a mossy stone — hidden beauty · Fair as a solitary star — unique worth · Symbol of innocence, simplicity, purity · Death reveals her significance to the speaker. (CO2)

13. Dominant mood of melancholy · Withdrawing "Sea of Faith" — loss of religious belief · Sound of pebbles brings "eternal note of sadness" · Contrast between the world's apparent beauty and its reality · Human love as the only refuge. (CO3)

14. Admiration for the skill of father and grandfather · Precision of spade work recalled with pride · Honest manual labour respected · Strong family tradition of the land · Speaker cannot continue it; the pen becomes his spade. (CO4)

15. Hours symbolise the relentless passage of time · Immortality without youth becomes a curse · The Hours "beat me down and marred and wasted me" · Continuous ageing and physical decay · Mental and emotional suffering; Tithonus longs for death. (CO3)

16. Blindness creates anxiety about serving God · Fears his one talent is now useless · Questions whether God exacts day-labour from the blind · Patience answers the murmuring doubt · God needs neither work nor gifts; faithful endurance is service — "They also serve who only stand and wait." (CO1)

17. Skylark springs upward like a cloud of fire · Fire imagery suggests brilliance, inspiration, purity · Flight into the blue deep — freedom and transcendence · Bird unseen, an "unbodied joy," while its song fills the sky · Union of nature, light and poetic imagination. (CO2)

18. Petrarchan conceit: lady is ice, lover is fire · Paradox — her cold is not melted by his heat, his fire is not quenched by her cold · Reversal of the natural order · Her hardness increases rather than yields · Concludes with the power of love to alter the course of nature. (CO1)

19. Enters casually, unsure why · Awkward, irreverent gestures; ignorance of church objects · Sceptical, detached, faintly mocking tone · Curiosity mixed with unease beneath the irony · Prepares for the later recognition of the church's serious value. (CO4)

(5 × 6 = 30)

Part C — Essay
Answer any 2 questions. Each question carries 15 marks

20. Theme of spiritual, enduring love · Parting to be accepted calmly · Comparison with the quiet death of virtuous men · Rejects "tear-floods" and public grief · Contrast between dull sublunary lovers and refined love · Gold beaten to airy thinness — expansion without breaking · Compass conceit — unity despite distance · Physical separation cannot weaken true love · Metaphysical features: conceit, wit, argument, logic · (CO1)

21. Medieval ballad setting and form · Knight meets a mysterious, beautiful lady · Romantic celebration of beauty, imagination, the supernatural · Idyllic wooing — garland, bracelets, elfin grot · Gothic elements: pale kings, death imagery, desolate landscape · Dream vision reveals danger and betrayal · Themes of illusion, enchantment, fatal love · Sedge withered, no birds sing — barrenness after enchantment · Ballad repetition and refrain heighten dramatic effect · (CO2)

22. Desire to escape city life ("pavements grey") · Innisfree as symbol of peace and simplicity · Self-sufficient rural life — cabin, bean-rows, hive · Nature offers spiritual and emotional comfort · Contrast between urban noise and rural tranquillity · Irish landscape and the Celtic Revival's national identity · Implicit critique of industrialisation and displacement · Rich natural imagery and musical rhythm · Peace attained through memory and imagination · (CO4)

23. Dramatic monologue reveals character indirectly · Duke: proud, possessive, authoritarian, connoisseur of art · His jealousy exposes insecurity · Duchess: innocent, warm, easily pleased, appreciative of life · "I gave commands; then all smiles stopped" — implied abuse of power · Silent listener (envoy) and the marriage negotiation · Irony: the Duke condemns himself while boasting · Neptune statue — control and possession · Patriarchal values; themes of power, art and objectification · (CO3)

(15 × 2 = 30)